Malaysian Flight Name Entry Optimization Project

Reducing MY Name Amendment Rates, Enhancing User Experience

July 9, 2025
IBU CSC UXA

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Trip.com

1. Research Overview

Project Background

0.97%
Contact per Order
CPO Jan-Jun 2025

7,079
Tickets Analyzed
Amendment requests

6
Months of Data
January - June 2025

0.028%
Complaint Rate
Complaint per order

Malaysia market faces **top 3 global** name-change rates, with **~1200 monthly tickets** due to passport name ambiguity (no surname/given name separation) and cultural connectors (bin/binti), causing **68.34% content addition + 49.39% content deletion** issue that increase MY check-in/on board issues and service costs.

This project employs desktop research, competitor benchmarking, and internal quantitative & qualitative analysis to optimize name-entry accuracy and reduce name-related costs.

Data Sources

- Government Documentation
- 10 Platform Benchmarks
- 7,079 Amendment Tickets
- CS Contact Analysis
- Customer Interviews

Key Findings

Our comprehensive analysis of Malaysian flight name entry issues has revealed challenges that span the entire user journey. These findings highlight systematic barriers that prevent users from correctly entering their names according to Malaysian naming conventions, leading to downstream complications during travel.

Pre-Booking: Knowledge prep missing

The main ethnic groups in Malaysia include Malays, Chinese, and Indians. Each group has its own naming conventions (bin/binti, a/l/a/p). Our website needs to provide more localized examples and passport guidance to prepare users for name entry.

→**Suggestion:** Enhanced ethnicity-specific FAQ and comparative airline rule table.

Name Entry: Terminology Confusion

Western "First/Last Name" concepts don't fit Malaysian naming structures where many don't use family surnames. This causes name reversals and cultural identifier omissions without proper ethnic-specific examples.

→**Suggestion:** Localized "Given/Family Name" interface with smart cultural prefix detection and multi-ethnic example library.

Pre-Payment: Weak Verification

Confirmation popups lack urgency and boarding denial risk reminder, unlike competitors. Users quickly bypass verification screens, missing the chance to catch errors before payment.

→**Suggestion:** High-impact verification popup with boarding denial risk warning and action-oriented confirmation button.

Post-Order: Buried Information

Name details get lost in wordy confirmation emails, causing users to miss name related information . Errors can be found during pre-travel document review when amendment is allowed.

→**Suggestion:** Make the name section stand out in emails, along with a stronger verification reminder.

Check-in/Boarding: Emergency Issues

There is little chance for last-minute name change, creating stressful situations where travelers face potential denied boarding with limited options.

→**Suggestion:** Enhance emergency handling strategies regarding name-related NTUA.

Smart Validation + Localization + User Education = Reduction in Issues

Research Methodology

Comprehensive 3-phase approach analyzing Malaysian name entry challenges

1 Desktop Research

- Malaysian naming systems study
- Passport structure analysis
- 5 airlines' name rules
- 6 OTA guidelines research
- Government regulations analysis

Global OTA(4): Trip.com, Agoda, Booking.com, Expedia
Local OTA(2): Traveloka, Mayflower Holiday
Top 5 MY Airline(5):
Malaysia Airlines (MH), AirAsia (AK), AirAsia X (D7), Batik Air (OD), China Southern (CZ)

Key Deliverable: Comprehensive report on naming conventions and airline rules

2 Competitive Testing

- 6 OTAs and 5 airlines tested
- Form designs recorded
- Innovative features analyzed
- Help systems benchmarked

Global OTA(4): Trip.com, Agoda, Booking.com, Expedia
Local OTA(2): Traveloka, Mayflower Holiday
Top 5 MY Airline(5):
Malaysia Airlines (MH), AirAsia (AK), AirAsia X (D7), Batik Air (OD), China Southern (CZ)

Research Output: Competitive analysis matrix with design patterns

3 Internal Insights

- 7,079 name change tickets analyzed
- 5 senior staff interviews
- Experience documentation
- CPO and complaint per order data

Special thanks to the following MY team for their precious insights and contributions to this project:

Arvin Singh, Arif Aziz, Esther Joshua A/P Mogan, Faris Zafri, Alageswary A/P Manimaran Bakthimalai, Hakimi Bin Hamdan, Amalul Ariffin

Extracted Findings: Error pattern taxonomy and front-line insights

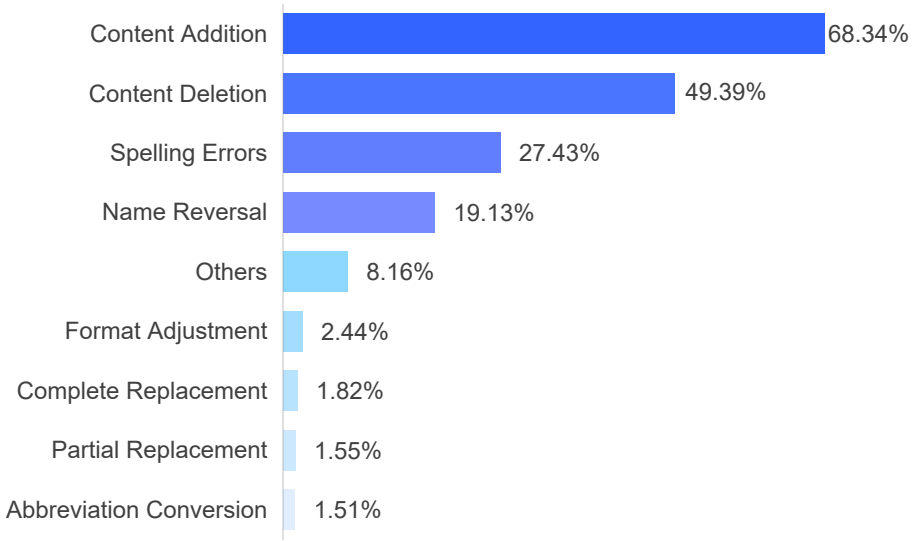
Data Timeframe: January-June 2025 | **Data Volume:** 7,079 amendment tickets | **Coverage:** 10 platforms, 5 employee interviews

Trip.com

2. Problem Analysis

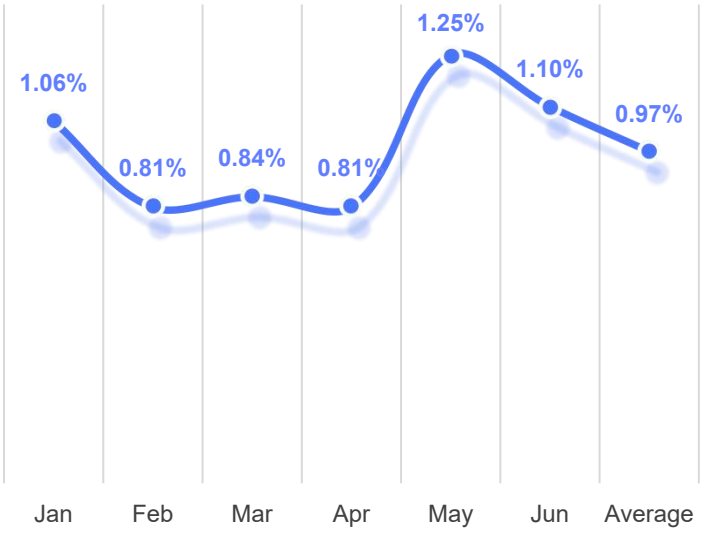
Operational Data Overview

Name Amendment Type Distribution



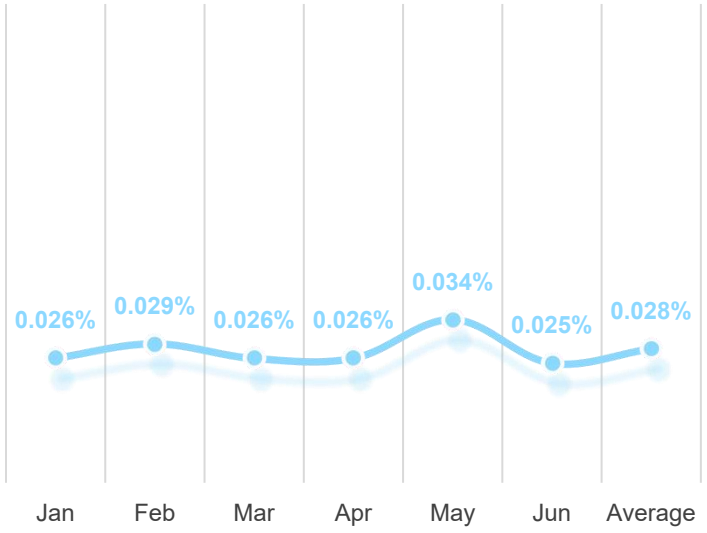
Source: Analysis of 7,079 amendment tickets [Jan-Jun 2025]
Note: Percentages sum to >100% as one name change can involve multiple types of modifications

CPO Trends



Source: Monthly operational data [Jan-Jun 2025]

Complaint per Order Trends



Source: Monthly customer service data [Jan-Jun 2025]

Key Insights & Operational Impact

Content Addition

68.34% of name changes involve adding content, including **23.46%** for bin/binti prefixes

Same-day Error Discovery

44.39% of name changes occur on the same day as booking, with **67.06%** in the first week

Trends after Improvement to be tracked

Both charts display **stable trends** with **fluctuations**, CPO and complaints per order will be monitored

Desktop Research Findings (1/2): Malay Name System Complexity

- **Passport Characteristics:** Malay passports have a single name field without surname/given name distinction, creating incompatibility with booking systems.

- **Ethnic Naming Rules:** Multi-ethnic population has diverse naming conventions:
  - **Malays:** Use bin (son of) or binti (daughter of) as patronymic identifiers; **Father's name is not a family name like in Western cultures**
  - **Chinese:** Family name first in Chinese order, **often with English names of which position varies in documents**, but Single syllable surname (e.g., LEE) always precedes given name
  - **Indian:** Include "a/l" (anak lelaki = son of), "a/p" (anak perempuan = daughter of) as markers; **Religious variations exists:** Sikhs add Singh/Kaur; Christians **may include English names**
  - **Sabah:** "Anak" as a patronymic indicator, meaning "child of," to denote lineage; "Anak lelaki" (son of) and "anak perempuan" (daughter of).

References: 1. Sayari Content Team. (2019). Naming Conventions on the Malay Peninsula. 2. Robustova, V. V. (2016). Anthroponymic system of Malaysia: Name popularity and culture shift.

- **Airline Rule Inconsistencies:** Major carriers enforce conflicting rules:
  - MH and AK differ in policies regarding long name entry: MH requires long names to be abbreviated, while AK asks for as many name parts as possible.
  - Airlines vary from one to another in name entry limits.
  - Airlines vary on single names: MH uses "Family Name" and FNU for "Given Name"; AK uses the single name for both fields.

(see further details on the next page).

Malay Passport Format

- Single name field (no surname separation)
- No standard format across ethnic groups
- Cultural identifiers included in main name

Malay Naming Example

Passport:	AHMAD BIN ABU BAKAR
Booking:	Given: AHMAD | Family: BIN ABU BAKAR
Components:	Given name: Ahmad | Patronymic: bin | Father's name: Abu Bakar

Chinese Malaysian Naming Example

Passport:	VINCENT TAN MING BAN
Booking:	Given: MING BAN VINCENT | Family: TAN
Components:	Family name: Tan | Chinese given: Ming Ban | English name: Vincent

Indian Malaysian Naming Example

Passport:	KUMAR A/L MUTHU
Booking:	Given: KUMAR | Family: A/L MUTHU
Components:	Given name: Kumar | Patronymic: a/l (anak lelaki) | Father's name: Muthu

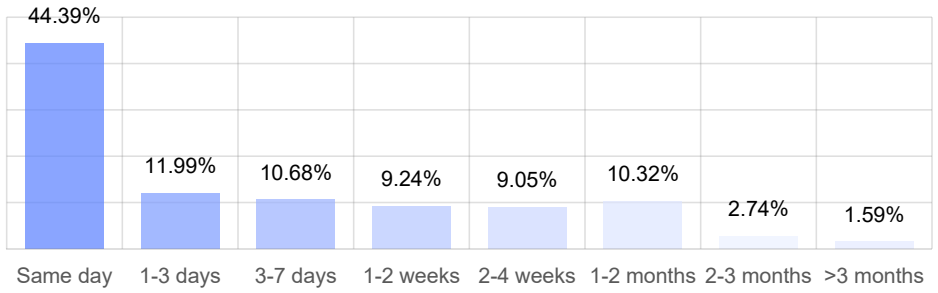
Desktop Research Findings (2/2): Major Airlines' Name Entry Rules Comparison

(Top 5 Name Amendment Tickets Airlines)

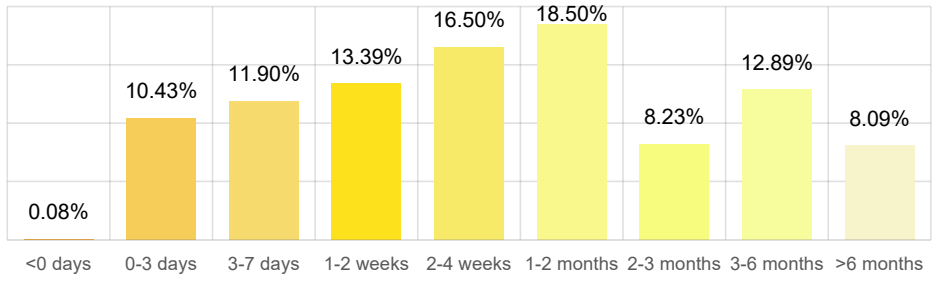
	MH	AK/D7	OD	CZ
Basic Rule	Passport not split surname/given name, process by MRZ format; MRZ uses single separator (<<) between surname/given, double separator (<<) between given names	Ensure name matches passport/ID exactly	Fill per ID printed name format	Ensure entered name matches document exactly
Char Limit	Surname max 40 chars, Given max 25 chars	Customer name length restricted, specifics unclear	Surname max 29 chars, min 2 chars, total First+Last max 60 chars	Not specified
Single Name	No surname: enter "FNU" in surname field; No given: enter "FNU" in given/middle field	If name contains only single name, fill same name in "Family Name/Surname" field	Single-word names require duplicate entry, e.g. Pattimura → PATTIMURA/PATTIMURA MR.	Not specified
Letter Processing	Use initials for given names in First Name field, full given names go to Last Name field, e.g. Moana Y → First: Moana, Last: YY	Not specified	Not specified	Not specified
Multi Name	Parse based on MRZ structure, suggest splitting method	Fill complete names as possible in respective fields	Example: 1-word names duplicate, e.g. Mohammad Hatta → HATTA/MOHAMMAD MR.	English names: Given name/Surname format
Special Char	Remove hyphens; replace with spaces, e.g. non-Roman chars need transliteration or romanization	Remove alias symbols; remove A/P or A/L unless appears in passport "Name" section; replace hyphens with spaces	Not specified	Chinese names use Pinyin, e.g. "Zhang Da" → "Zhang/Mida"
Long Names	Original: Putra Muhammad Aniq Amirul Mukhtar Shah Bin Putra Muhammad Akbar Shah Entry: First & Middle Name: PutraMuhammadAniqAMS, Last name/Surname: BinPutraMuhammadAkbarShah Exceeding char limits: 1. Remove spaces 2. Abbreviate: Given names: first 2 chars each, surname: full except last	Fill as many names as possible in First/Given and Family/Surname	Specify: max 29 chars surname, min 2 chars, total max 60 chars	Not specified
Bin/Binti	Enter in Last name field	Enter in Family name field	Not specified	Not specified
System Limit	Provide detailed char limit description	Cannot save, special chars, no length restrictions	Names combined with title info	Not specified
Adult w/Infant	Provide adult+infant name abbreviation details	Not specified	Not specified	Not specified
Chinese Names	Provide Ming/Chinese name entry method	Not specified	Not specified	Not specified
Name Change	Not specified	Cannot change name to another person after booking confirmation; certain cases allow name correction	Not specified	Not specified
Member Req	Not specified	AirAsia member account name must match passport name exactly	Not specified	Not specified
Doc Detail	Very detailed, includes passport samples and MRZ parsing	Detailed, includes multiple examples and processing methods	Basic requirements and examples	Brief description
Official Link	LINK	LINK	LINK	LINK

Customer Behavior Patterns

Days from Order Date to Name Change Request



Days from Name Change Request to Flight Departure



Source: Analysis of customer service logs [Data Analysis]

Emergency Amendment Insights

> *"I think 20 percent of the passengers only realize when they do the check-in on the website or at the airport."*

> *"Normally, they realize it less than 24 hours before departure, when they try to do online check-in or arrive at the airport. They notice the name is incorrect, and airline staff advise them."*

[Internal Interviews]

First-time vs. Repeat Customer Behavior

Behavioral Dimension	First-time Customers	Repeat Customers	Key VOC Evidence
Error Frequency	High error rates	Continue making errors despite experience	• *"I encounter more new customers" (Amalul)* • *"Most of the time, they will be repeat customers" (Alageswary)*
Cognitive Processing	Overwhelmed by multiple variables	False confidence, make assumptions	• *"First-time flyers or someone else books for them" (Amalul)* • *"They thought this specific policy applies to all airlines" (Faris)*
Problem Discovery	Immediate confusion OR delayed recognition	Delayed discovery during routine verification	• *"They would like to further confirm first" (Faris)* • *"Wait until 1-2 weeks before departure date" (Faris)*
Error Types	Fundamental classification errors (Which field for which name part)	Context-specific errors (Sequence/order within correct fields)	• *"Confused about first name and last name" (Faris)* • *"Wrong name sequence not arrangement" (Faris)*
Help-Seeking	Proactive help-seeking when confused	Assumption-based proceeding	• *"Some aren't aware...first-time flyers" (Amalul)* • *"They thought they knew how to put the name" (Faris)*
Cultural Translation	Raw challenge, no established strategies	Developed personal strategies (often incorrect)	• *"We don't have specific columns for first and last name" (Amalul)* • *"Li is the first name...but actually Li is the family name" (Faris)*

Source: Customer behavior analysis [Internal Interviews]

Immediate Recognition Pattern

44.39% of name changes occur on the same day as booking, suggesting customers quickly realize errors after completing reservations

Improve Urgent Amendment Procedure

22.33% of changes occur within 7 days of departure, with **10.43%** being urgent (0-3 days before flight). Around 0.1% happened on the same day, which might cause NTUA.

Advance Planning Insight

70.80% of name changes are made at least 1 month before departure, indicating most travelers will check details in advance

Competitive Advantage Analysis (1/2)

Comprehensive review of 10 platforms: 4 International OTAs, 2 Regional OTAs, and 4 Airlines

✓ *Has feature* ✗ *lack of feature* ◐ *uncompleted feature*

Feature	International OTAs				Regional OTAs		Airlines			
	Trip.com	Expedia	Agoda	Booking	Traveloka	Mayflower	MAS	AirAsia	Batik Air	China Southern
1. MRZ Guidance	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
2. Local Name Examples	◐	◐	✗	✗	◐	✓	✓	✓	◐	✗
3. Title/Honorific Support	✗	◐	✗	✗	◐	◐	✓	✓	✓	✗
4 . Gender-Cultural Validation	✗	✗	✗	✗	◐	◐	✓	◐	✗	✗
5. Help System Capabilities	◐	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	◐	◐
6. Name Verification Reminder	✓	◐	◐	◐	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
7. Special Name Handling	◐	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	◐	◐	✗
8. Smart Validation	◐	✓	✓	◐	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
9. Single Name Handling	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	◐	✓	✓	✓	✗
10 Ethnic Coverage	✓	◐	✗	✗	◐	✓	✓	✓	◐	✗

Source: Competitive testing results across 10 platforms (6 OTAs + 4 Airlines) [January-June 2025]

Feature Explaination

Feature	Explanation	Feature	Explanation
1. MRZ Guidance	Passport scanning to auto-fill names	6. Name Verification Reminder	Prompts to check name matches ID
2. Local Name Examples	Shows Malaysian name format samples	7. Special Name Handling	Supports long/complex names
3. Title/Honorific Support	Includes Mr./Ms./Dato options	8. Smart Validation	Auto-checks name format errors
4. Gender/Cultural Indication	Detects gender from name patterns	9. Single Name Handling	Accepts users with one name only
5. Help System Capabilities	Provides name entry assistance	10 Ethnic Coverage	Supports all Malaysian ethnic names

Competitive Advantage Analysis (2/2)

Comprehensive review of 10 platforms: 4 International OTAs, 2 Regional OTAs, and 4 Airlines

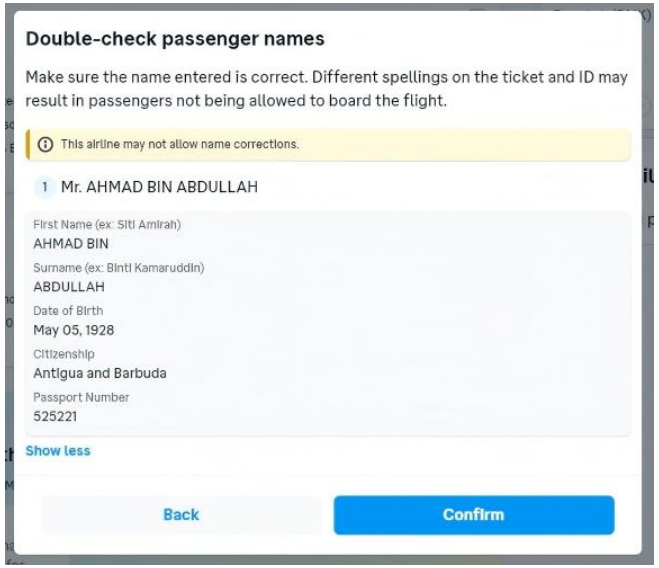
Trip.com Feature Gaps

- **No MRZ guidance**: Missing visual passport interpretation
- **No local honorifics**: Lacks support for Malaysian titles (Dato, Datuk)
- **Limited special name handling**: Inadequate for names with A/L, A/P, @, etc.

Best Practices

- **Malaysia Airlines**: Rich local honorifics (Dato, Datuk, Tun), comprehensive ethnic examples, visual MRZ guidance
- **Traveloka**: More detailed popup verification + detailed FAQ, visual MRZ guidance
- **AirAsia**: Multi-national ethnic coverage, real-time validation with feedback

Traveloka Popup Verification



AirAsia Name Format Examples

Multiple names formatting

Our system does not accept symbols, special characters and has a limit on the length of our guest's names.

1. **Names with alias '@', 'A/P' or 'A/L'**

   If your name is spelled with a '@' or second name in your Identification Card, remove the '@' , insert a space between the two names.

   If your name contains 'A/P' or 'A/L' remove it unless it appears in the 'Name' section of your passport.

   Examples:

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Aliff@Imran Bin Ahmad	Aliff Imran	Bin Ahmad
Lim Swee Teng @ Lim Swee Tin	Lim Swee Teng	Lim Swee Tin
Manimala A/P Murthy Muthu	Manimala	AP Murthy Muthu

2. **Names with hyphen**

   If your name is spelled with a hyphen '-', please replace it with a space.

   Examples:

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Laura Applebee-Jones	Laura	Applebee Jones
Lim Ker-Hoong	Ker Hoong	Lim

3. **Single Names**

   If your name only consists of a single name, e.g: Suryadi, please fill up the "Family Name / Surname" field with the same name filled up in the "Given Name" field.

   Examples:

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Suryadi	Suryadi	Suryadi

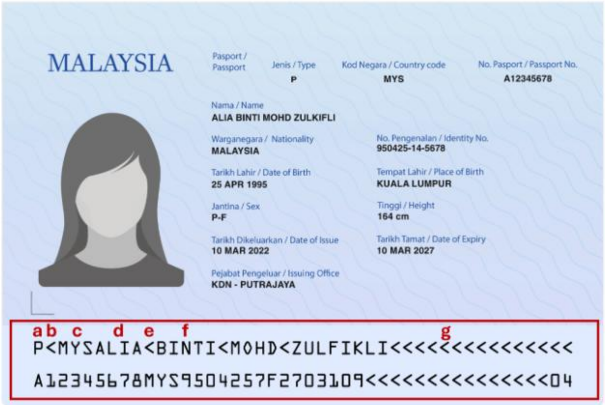
4. **Long Names**

   If you have a long name and cannot fill in your full name while making a booking, we advise you to fill in as many of your names as possible in the First/Given Name and Family Name/Surname.

   Examples:

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Muhammad Faizal Zulkarnain bin Muhammad Zulfikli Amiruddin Syahrezan	Muhammad Faizal Zulkarnain bin	Muhammad Zulfikli Amiruddin Syahr

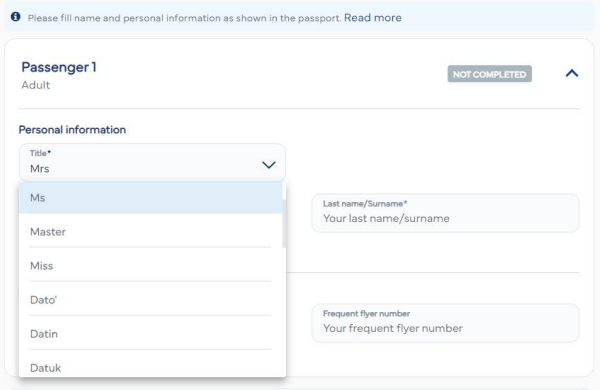
MH Passport MRZ Guide



Description

Item	Input	Description
a)	P	Indicates that this is a passport
b)	<	The separator (chevron)
c)	MYS	Country code e.g. Malaysia
d)	ALIA	Name
e)	<< OR <	The separator (chevron)
f)	BINTI, MOHD, ZULKIFLI	Name
g)	<<<<<<	Padding to fill up the rest of the space

MH Local Title Options



Problem Landscape - User Journey Mapping

	Pre-booking preparation	Name entry in progress	Order submission	Post-order confirmation	Check-in boarding
Cognitive Layer: User understanding bias	Users' unawareness of rules Lack of preventive education	First/Last confusion		Unaware of name modification details	
Interaction Layer: Interface design flaws		No MRZ guidance Lack of local examples	Weak confirmation process		
System Layer: Technical feature gaps		No bin/binti validation	No mandatory verification		
Operational Layer: Process mechanism issues					Difficult emergency handling

Problem annotation legend:

Desktop Research | Data Analysis | Competitive Testing | Internal Interviews

High Impact (>20%) | Medium Impact (10-20%) | Low Impact (<10%)

Trip.com

4. Insights & Solution

Pre-booking: Add a Name Entry Guide

Problem

- Help content insufficient, especially for Malaysian name complexities *[Competitive Testing]*
- Users confused about airline-specific rules *[Internal Interviews]*

Voice of Internal Interview

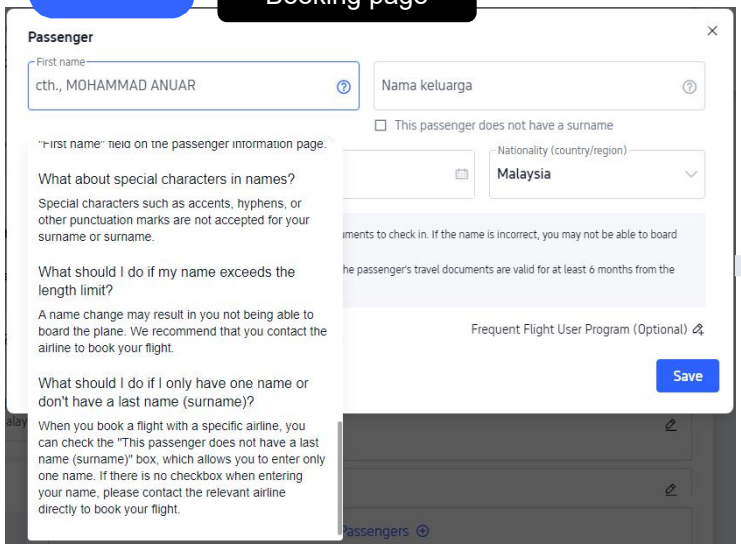
"I think that's the main part where passengers get confused about how to key in their name on the booking page." - Ex-customer Agent from MH airline [Internal Interview]

Suggestion

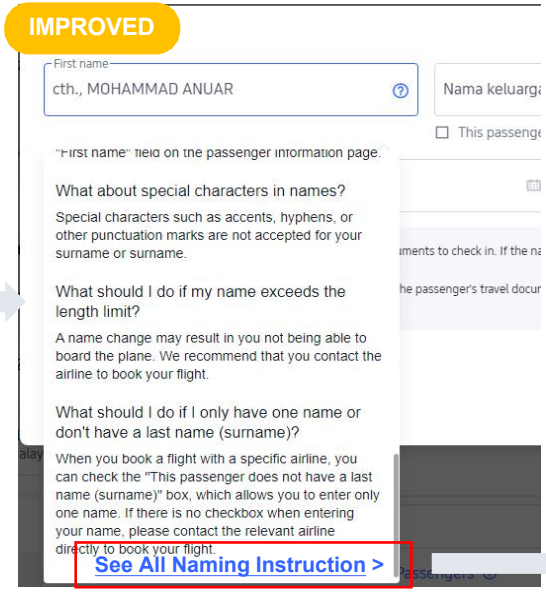
1. Create a FAQ page with embedded frontend name guidance links and folded sections

- **Passport name reading instructions** with MRZ zone interpretation
- **Categorize filling guidance** with examples for various ethnic name formats
- **List airline-specific rules** based on research and testing

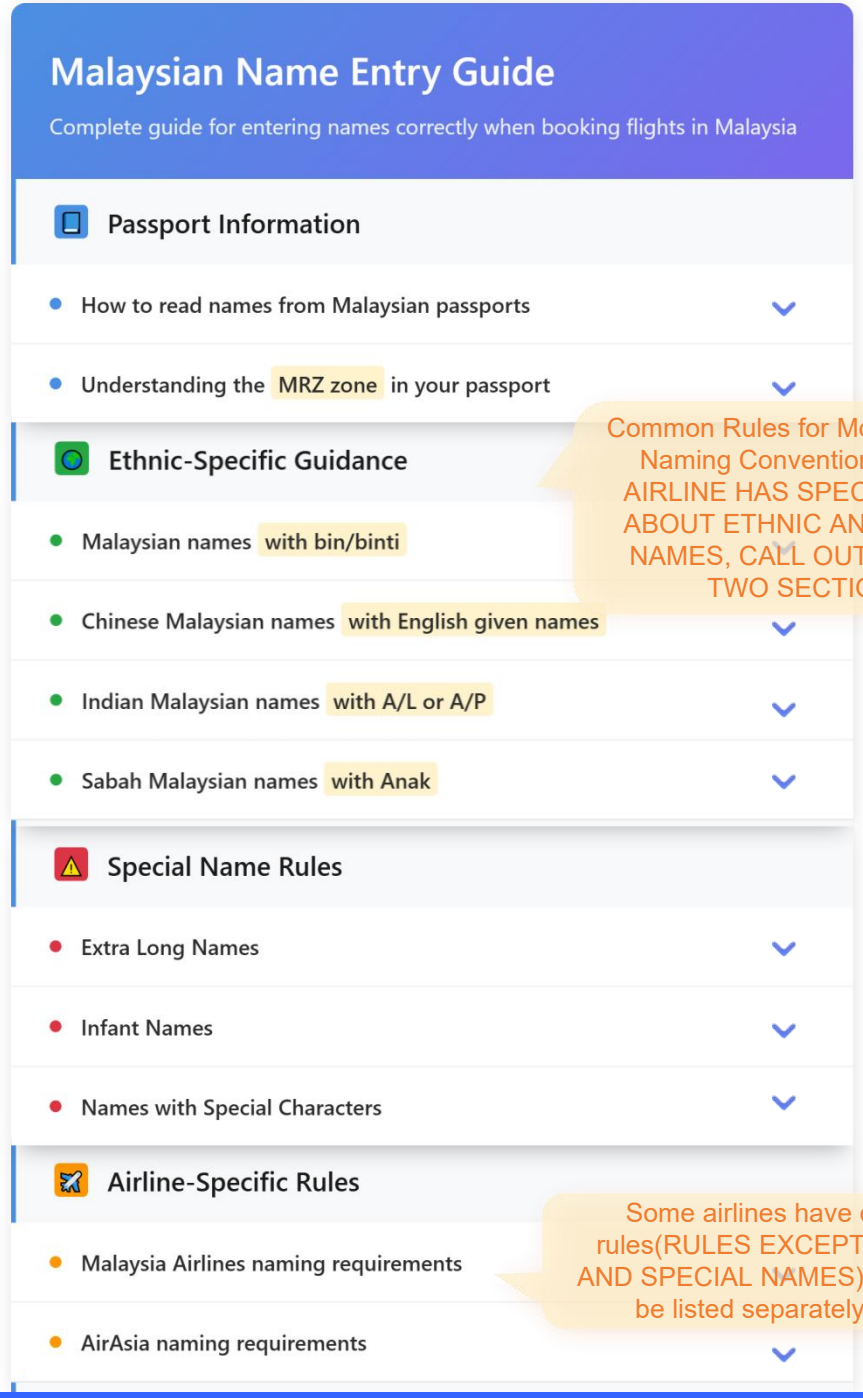
CURRENT Booking page



IMPROVED



Direct to

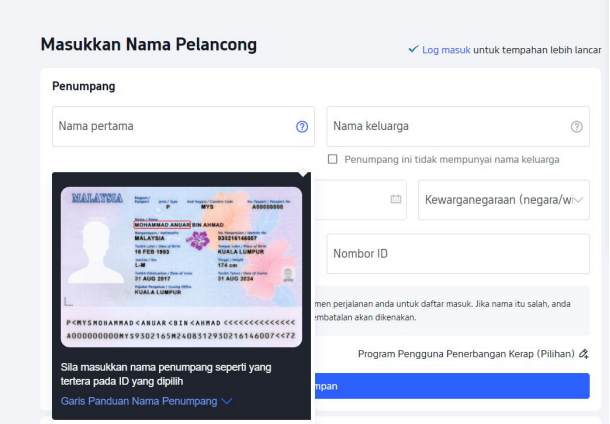


Name Entry: Optimize Help System

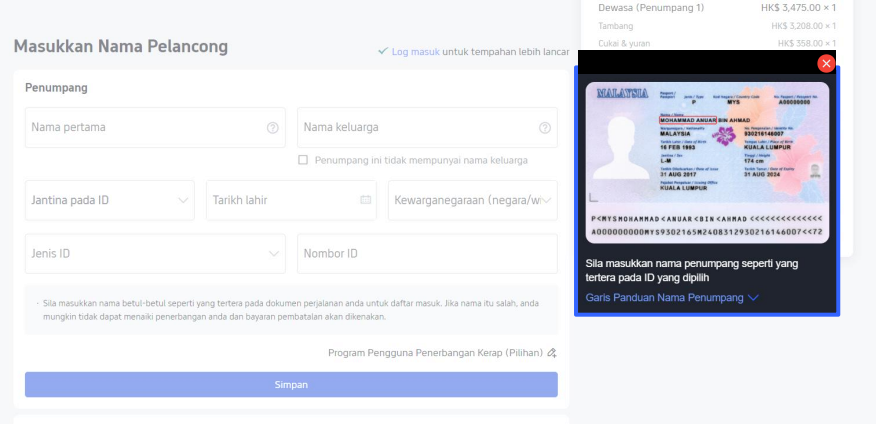
Booking page

2. Clicking the example image changes it from hover to **persistent on the right or left**, allowing users to close it. (***IQ: 44631532***, status: sumission, estimated solved time: 2025-08-11)

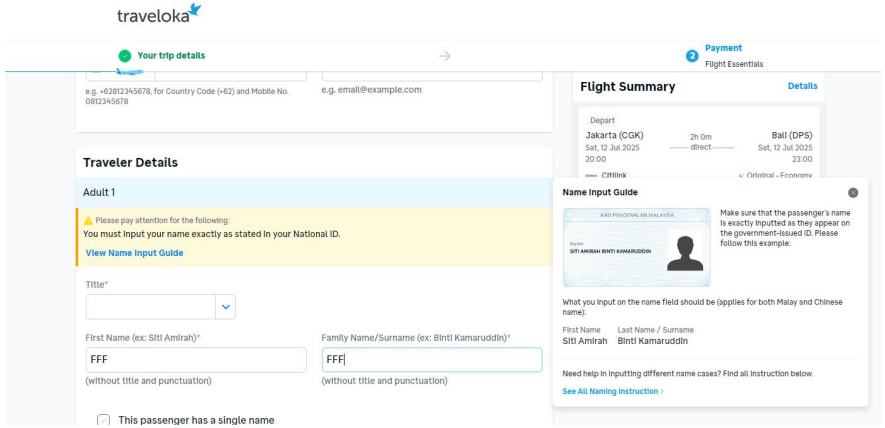
CURRENT



IMPROVED



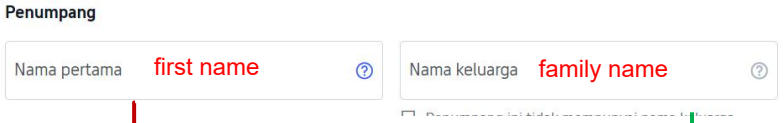
COMPETITOR



3. Example name order **matches input fields**. （***IQ: 44632708***, status: sumission, estimated solved time: 2025-08-11)

CURRENT

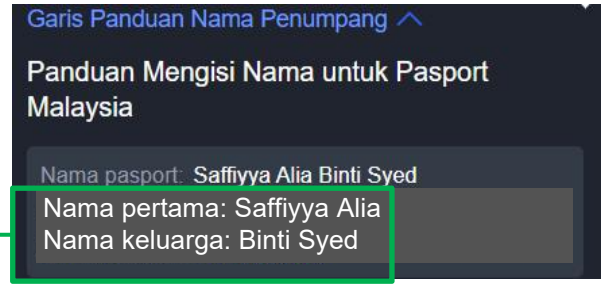
family name
first name



Name example sequence align with filling column

Current name example sequence given is not aligned with the filling column

IMPROVED



first name
family name

Name Entry: Interface Terminology Localization

Booking page

Problem

- **Name Reversal: 19.13%** of amendments due to name reversal errors *[Internal Data Analysis]*
- **Cultural Mismatch:** Malaysian users don't differentiate "First/Last" name as Western users do *[Internal Interviews]*
- **User Cognitive Bias:** Malaysian Chinese users often reverse family/given name order *[Desktop Research]*

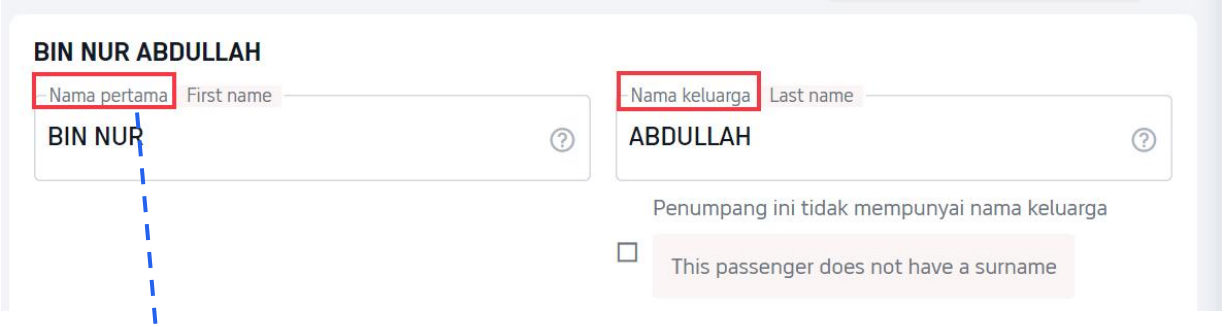
Voice of Internal Interview

" Using 'Given Name' and 'Family Name' makes it clear to customers (e.g., 'Given Name' = your personal name). But 'First Name/Last Name' confuses people—many aren't sure if 'First Name' means their family name or personal name. " - - Ex-customer Agent from Agoda [Internal Interview]

Suggestion

1. **Terminology Localization:** Replace "**Nama pertama** (First Name) " with "**Nama Pemberian** (Given Name) " *[Internal Interview]*
2. **Cultural Context (optional):** Add a localized terminology explanation specific to Malay naming customs *[Desktop Research]*

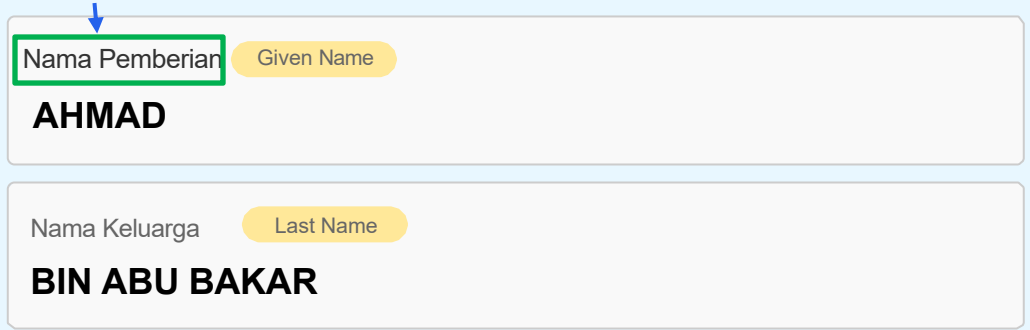
CURRENT



Causes confusion for Malays who may reverse the order

IMPROVED

Localized Solution



Cultural Context: In Malay naming conventions, the patronymic "bin" (son of) or "binti" (daughter of) connects the given name to the father's name, making "Given Name/Family Name" terminology clearer than "First Name/Last Name" for Malaysian users.

Name Entry: *special callout:* Passport MRZ Guidance System

Name Guidance FAQ page

Problem

- **Users don't know how to correctly read names** from passport, causing spelling errors *[Competitive Testing]*
- **Malaysian passport names** don't follow First/Last name structure *[Desktop Research]*
- **Cultural identifiers** (bin/binti) often misplaced when transferring from passport *[Internal Data Analysis]*

Competitive Edge

Malaysia Airlines and Traveloka already provide visual MRZ guidance, giving them a competitive advantage in user experience.

Suggestion

1. **Visual MRZ Zone Display:** Highlight the machine- readable zone on sample passport
2. **Field-by-Field Explanation:** Interactive breakdown of passport fields
3. **Malaysian-specific Guidelines:** Special instructions for multi-ethnic names

Note: Due to unclear MRZ name conversion rules of other airlines, our MRZ guideline is for reference only. Prioritizing MRZ in user guidance requires further validation.

Understanding Your Passport MRZ

MALAYSIA
Passport / Pasport

Name / Nama: ALIA BINTI MOHD ZULKIFLI

Passport No: A12345678

```
P<MYSALIA<BINTI<MOHD<ZULKIFLI<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<
A12345678MYS9904257F2703109<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<04
```

MRZ Components Explained

Line 1 Breakdown:

```
P<MYSALIA<BINTI<MOHD<ZULKIFLI<<<<<<<<<<<<<<
```

P = Document type (P for Passport)
< = Separator character (chevron)
MYS = Country code (Malaysia)
ALIA<BINTI<MOHD<ZULKIFLI = Full name (separated by single chevrons)
<<... = Filler characters to complete the line

Line 2 Breakdown:

```
A12345678MYS9904257F2703109<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<04
```

A12345678 = Passport number
MYS = Nationality (Malaysian)
9904257 = Date of birth (YYMMDD format + check digit)
F = Gender (F=Female, M=Male)
2703109 = Passport expiry date (YYMMDD format + check digit)
<<... = Filler characters
04 = Check digits for data verification

Key Points for Name Entry:

- Names are separated by single chevrons (<)
- Double chevrons (<<) indicate the end of the name section
- All names appear in CAPITAL LETTERS
- No punctuation marks are included

Name Entry: Multi-Ethnic Example Library Development

Problem: Prefix-Related Changes accournt for **31.55%** of all name changes. Frequent errors for special ethnic names across Malaysia's diverse population groups
[Internal Data Analysis + Internal Interviews]

Suggestion:

1. Add an additional common error **Indian name example with A/L or A/P** format on the booking page as one of the most common errors *(IQ:44640632)*
2. On the name guidance FAQ page, provide **more detailed examples with visual diagrams** tailored to specific ethnicities, especially for Malaysian passport formats, as shown below. *[Competitive Testing]*

CURRENT Booking page

Panduan Mengisi Nama untuk Pasport Malaysia

Nama pasport: Saffiyya Alia Binti Syed
Nama keluarga: Binti Syed
Nama pertama: Saffiyya Alia
Malay

Nama pasport: Vincent Tan Ming Ban
Nama keluarga: Tan
Nama pertama: Vincent Ming Ban
Chinese

Nama pasport: Vasuthevan Thambiran
Nama keluarga: Thambiran
Nama pertama: Vasuthevan
Indian

Nama pasport: Ng Ah Hock
Nama keluarga: Ng
Nama pertama: Ah Hock
Traditional Chinese

Add

IMPROVED

Nama pasport: Priya A/P Muthusamy
Nama pertama (Given Name): Priya
Nama keluarga (Family Name): AP Muthusamy

Name Guidance FAQ page

Malaysian Name Entry Guide

Complete guide for entering names correctly when booking flights in Malaysia

Passport Information

- How to read names from Malaysian passports
- Understanding the MRZ zone in your passport

Ethnic-Specific Guidance

- Malaysian names with bin/binti
- Chinese Malaysian names with English given names
- Indian Malaysian names with A/L or A/P
- Sabah Malaysian names with Anak

Clicking each ethnic guidance banner will display detailed visual examples for name input based on that ethnic group.

MY Muslim Malaysian Name

Original Name:
AHMAD BIN ABU BAKAR

Given Name
AHMAD

Family Name
BIN ABU BAKAR

"Bin" means "son of" and should be included in family name

IN Indian Malaysian Name

Original Name:
MUTHU A/L SAMY

Given Name
MUTHU

Family Name
A/L SAMY

A/L (anak lelaki) means "son of" and should be included in family name

Name Entry: Special Name Handling Guidance

Problem:

High error rates stem from special name cases—**extra-long names**, **infant-adult name mix-ups**, and **special characters** like @, A/L, and hyphens causing validation hiccups. *[Internal Data Analysis]*

Voice of Internal Interview

" Infant name entry poses challenges: Malaysia Airlines lacks dedicated fields for infants, causing overly long names when combined with mother's name in the same field, which complicates processing. " - Ex-customer Agent from MH airline [Internal Interview]

Suggestion

Provide **detailed examples** featuring special names on the Name Guidance FAQ page. *[Internal Interview]*

IMPROVED

COMPETITOR

Traveloka and AirAsia provide special name handling guides, providing a clearer guidance for customers with special name cases to address the confusion *[Competitive Testing]*

traveloka(left) & airasia (right) name guidance FAQ page

Names with Special Characters (, . -, etc.)

Delete special characters when you fill in your name

Name on travel document
KELLY-ANNE SMITH

How to fill in your name in the column:

First Name	Family Name
KELLYANNE	SMITH

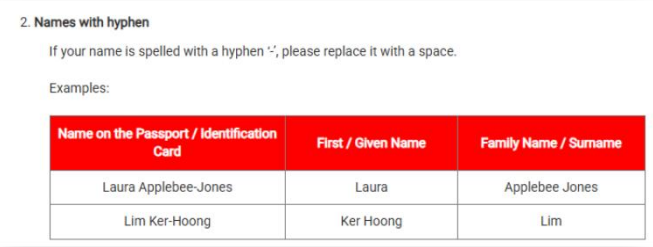
1. Names with alias '@', 'A/P' or 'A/L'

If your name is spelled with a '@' or second name in your Identification Card, remove the '@' , insert a space between the two names.

If your name contains 'A/P' or 'A/L' remove it unless it appears in the 'Name' section of your passport.

Examples:

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Aliff@Imran Bin Ahmad	Aliff Imran	Bin Ahmad
Lim Swee Teng @ Lim Swee Tin	Lim Swee Teng	Lim Swee Tin
Manimala A/P Murthy Muthu	Manimala	AP Murthy Muthu



2. Names with hyphen

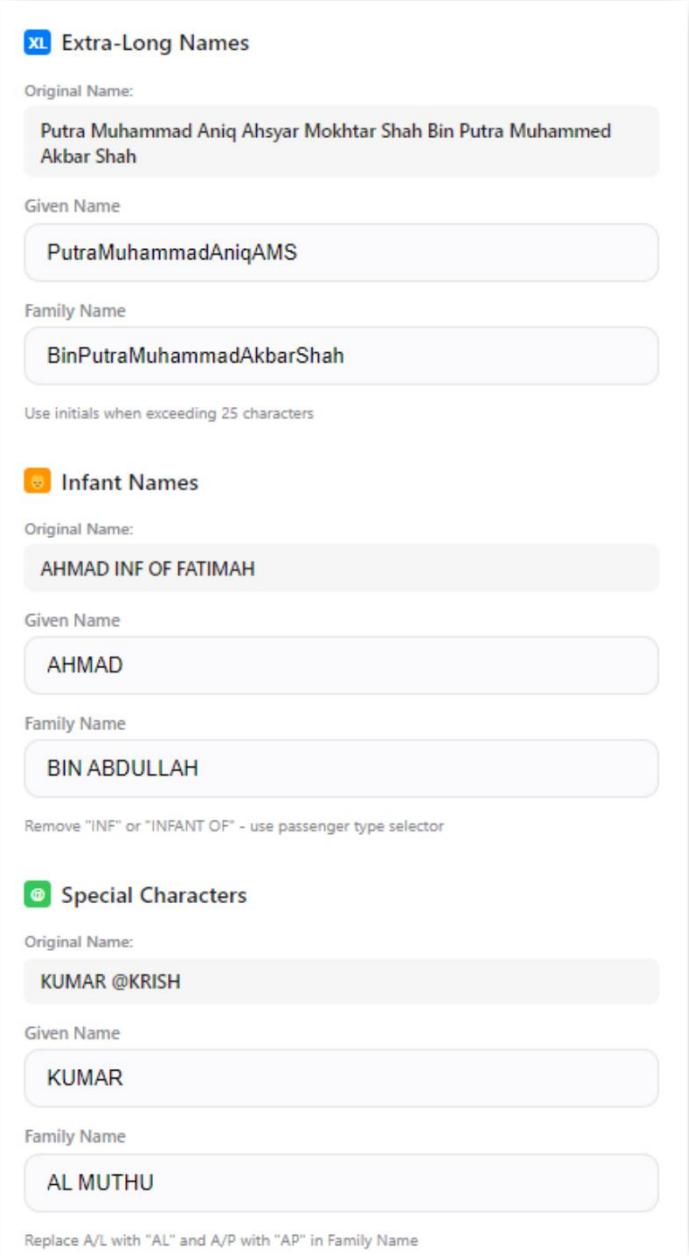
If your name is spelled with a hyphen '-', please replace it with a space.

Examples:

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Laura Applebee-Jones	Laura	Applebee Jones
Lim Ker-Hoong	Ker Hoong	Lim

Name Guidance FAQ page

(Prototypes after improvement as below)



XL Extra-Long Names

Original Name:
Putra Muhammad Aniq Ahsyar Mokhtar Shah Bin Putra Muhammed Akbar Shah

Given Name
PutraMuhammadAniqAMS

Family Name
BinPutraMuhammadAkbarShah

Use initials when exceeding 25 characters

Infant Names

Original Name:
AHMAD INF OF FATIMAH

Given Name
AHMAD

Family Name
BIN ABDULLAH

Remove "INF" or "INFANT OF" - use passenger type selector

Special Characters

Original Name:
KUMAR @KRISH

Given Name
KUMAR

Family Name
AL MUTHU

Replace A/L with "AL" and A/P with "AP" in Family Name

IMPROVED *(Prototypes after improvement as below)* Booking page

Name Entry: Prefix Entry Fixes

Smart Detection & Prefix Reminder

Problem:

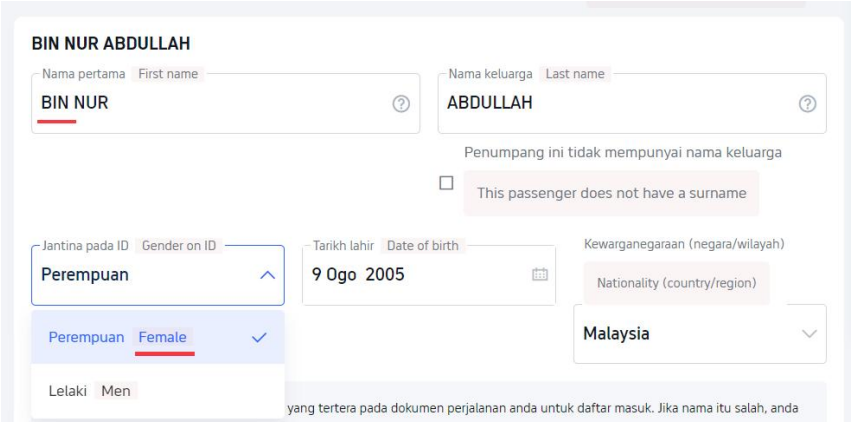
- **68.34%** of amendments are content additions, **23.87%** resulting from adding missing Malay prefixes (bin/binti) *[Internal Data Analysis]*
- **1.55%** of amendments involve partial replacement, primarily bin/binti gender prefix errors *[Internal Data Analysis]*

Suggestion

1. Smart validation that guides without blocking submission
2. Add a reminder to include prefixes (e.g., bin/binti) if present on the passport.

CURRENT

No specific detection/verification about prefix and name (e.g. no detection when a female enter 'Bin' in her name which is wrong)



2. Cultural Identifier Position Check

Verify correct placement of bin/binti/A/L/A/P/anak within name fields

Given Name: Nur Amira binti

Family Name: Ismail

⚠ Cultural identifier 'binti' should be in family name field

* Please include any name prefixes shown on your passport (e.g., bin/binti).

1. Gender Matching Validation

Auto-detect gender prefix mismatch between selected gender and entered name

Gender: Female

Family Name: bin Abdullah

⚠ Gender mismatch detected: For female passengers, should 'bin' be 'binti'?

* Please include any name prefixes shown on your passport (e.g., bin/binti).

Note: System provides guidance without blocking submission

Name Entry: Airline-specific Rule Adaptation

Name Guidance FAQ page

Problem: Different airline rules vary significantly for Malaysian passengers, yet users remain unaware *[Desktop Research + Internal Interviews]*

Key insight: Customer service inquiries involve confusion about airline-specific requirements that differ from passport format *[Internal Interviews]*

Suggestion

On the name guidance FAQ page, list **common Malaysian airline rules** with visual examples and clear indicators for special cases.

Malaysian Name Entry Guide

Complete guide for entering names correctly when booking flights in Malaysia

Passport Information

- How to read names from Malaysian passports
- Understanding the MRZ zone in your passport

Ethnic-Specific Guidance

- Malaysian names with bin/binti
- Chinese Malaysian names with English given names
- Indian Malaysian names with A/L or A/P
- Sabah Malaysian names with Anak

Airline-Specific Rules

- Malaysia Airlines naming requirements
- AirAsia naming requirements

IMPROVED

click on airline banner, will show detailed specific rules of each common airline in malaysia

(Prototypes after improvement as below)

Malaysia Airlines — Critical Rule

Single Name Requirement: For passengers with only one name, "FNU" (First Name Unknown) must be entered in the surname field

Example: Passport name "AHMAD" → Given: AHMAD | Family: FNU

AirAsia — Special Rule

Cultural Identifier Requirements: "bin/binti" MUST be included exactly as shown in passport **Example:** "Mohd Ali Ahmad Bin Mohd Abu"
→ Given: Mohd Ali Ahmad | Family: Bin Mohd Abu

Name on the Passport / Identification Card	First / Given Name	Family Name / Surname
Mohd Ali Ahmad Bin Mohd Abu	Mohd Ali Ahmad	Bin Mohd Abu
Deepika Kumar	Deepika	Kumar

Batik Air — Special Rule

Title Requirements: Titles (Dr, Dato, Datuk) must be entered in the title field only, NOT in name fields
Example: "DR. AHMAD ISMAIL" → Title: Dr | Given: AHMAD | Family: ISMAIL

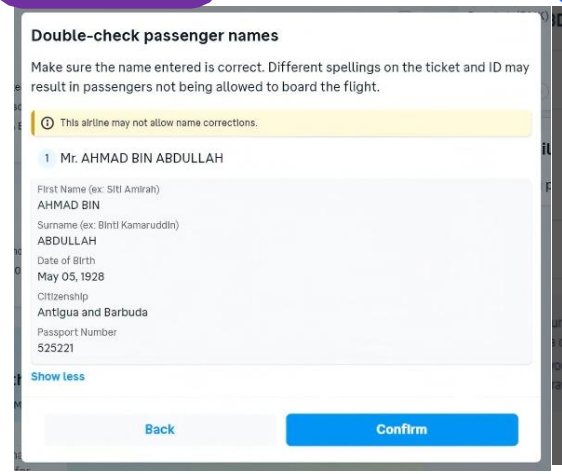
Before Payment: Double Name Verification

Booking page

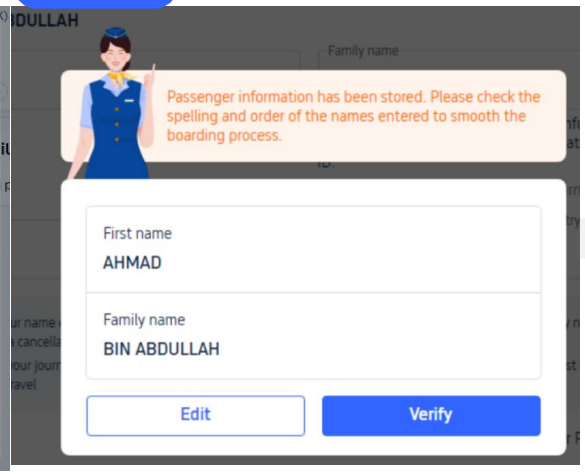
Problem: The current name verification pop-up before payment is less effective than competitors. Internal data shows users often rush through this step, ignoring name accuracy, resulting in more post-booking name correction requests.*[Internal Interviews & Data Analysis]*

Pop-up reminder before payment: (left) Traveloka (right) Trip.com

COMPETITOR



CURRENT



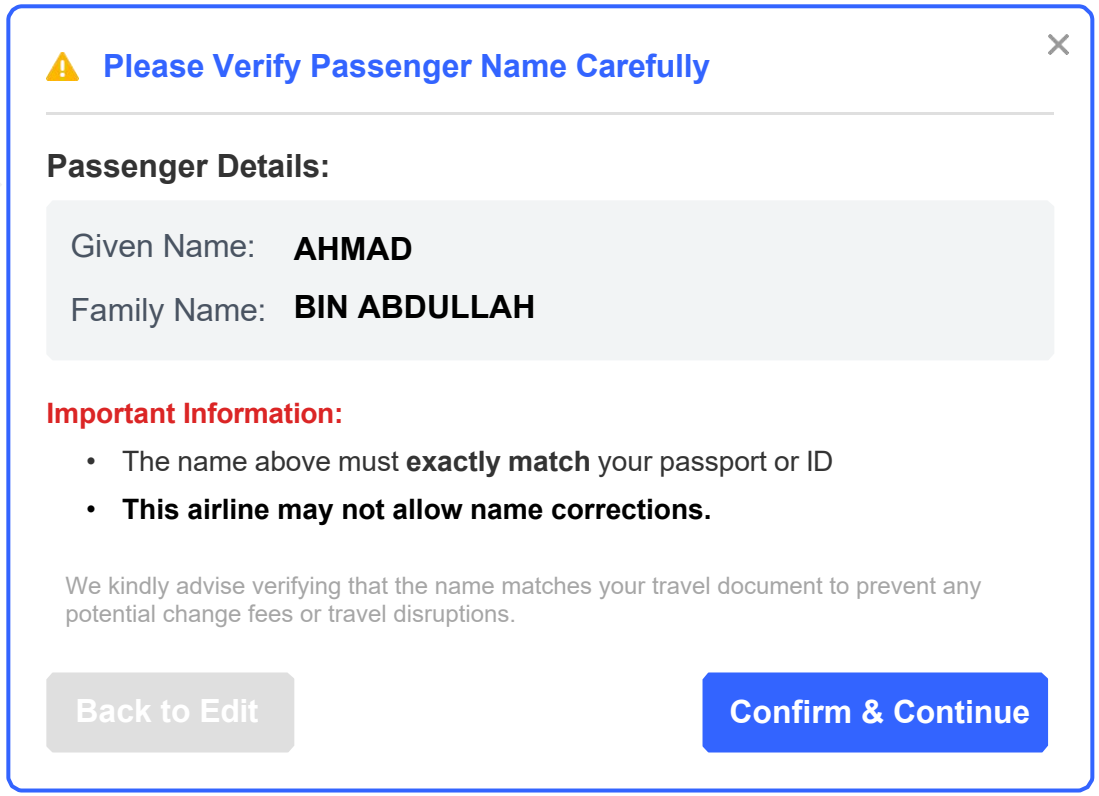
Traveloka Advantage:

- Early warning to prevent boarding rejection
- Clear airline rules reminder
- Complete ID recheck with visual examples

Suggestion

1. Add a clear reminder in the pop-up that **name mistakes may lead to denied boarding**, along with **airline name change policy details**.
2. Make the pop-up more eye-catching so users don't skip over it.
3. Change "verify" to "confirm & continue" to better match how users think when checking their names.

IMPROVED *(Prototypes after improvement as below)*



Post-Order: Strong Reminder Before Ticket Issuance

Payment successful page

Problem: Users often discover name errors only when **confirming or retrieving their booking, which is typically too late**.

This results in **missing the critical window between order placement and ticket issuance**—when name corrections are still free and simple. As a result, users face higher service costs, risk of denied boarding, and increased frustration.

[*Internal Interviews*]

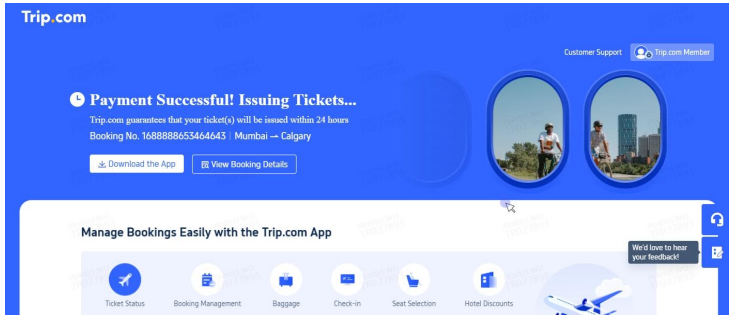
Voice of Internal Interview

" Most of the time customers will realize that they put a wrong name when they try to check the booking with the airline or they try to reconfirm their booking details with us or even with the airline to check their booking details itself. " (Former Agoda MY employee)

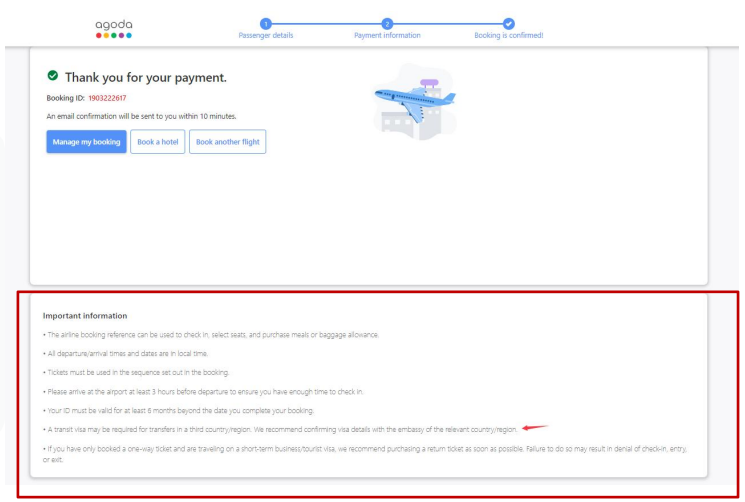
Suggestion

Add a second "Name Verification Reminder" between **order placement** and **ticket issuance** to reduce late error discovery and give users a chance to **cancel or rebook if name error found** before ticket issuance.

CURRENT

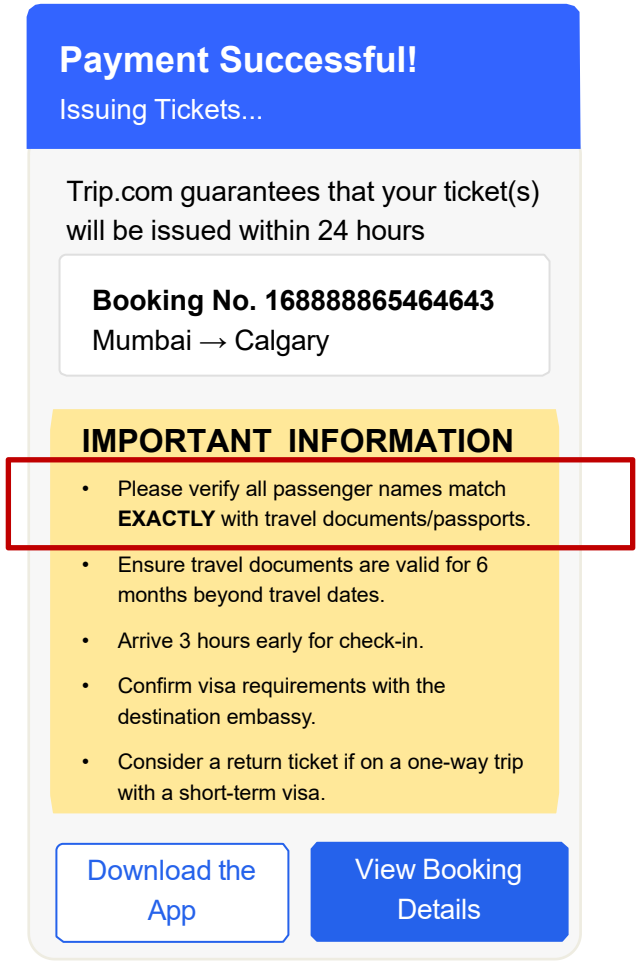


COMPETITOR



Agoda booking payment successful page:
1/ has a specific section to remind important information

IMPROVED *(Prototypes after improvement as below)*



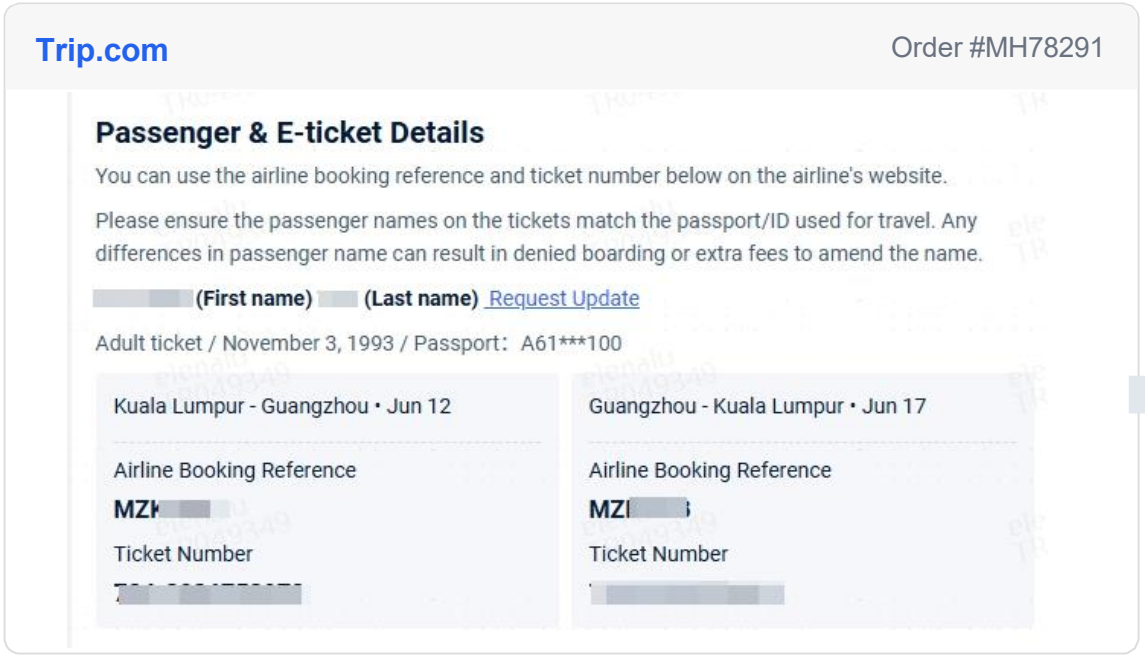
Post-Order: Strong Reminder in Confirmation Email

Problem: Users often **spot name mistakes only after getting the confirmation email, but the current name section is too weak to prompt rechecking.** This can lead to missed free correction windows or even denied boarding. *[Internal interview]*

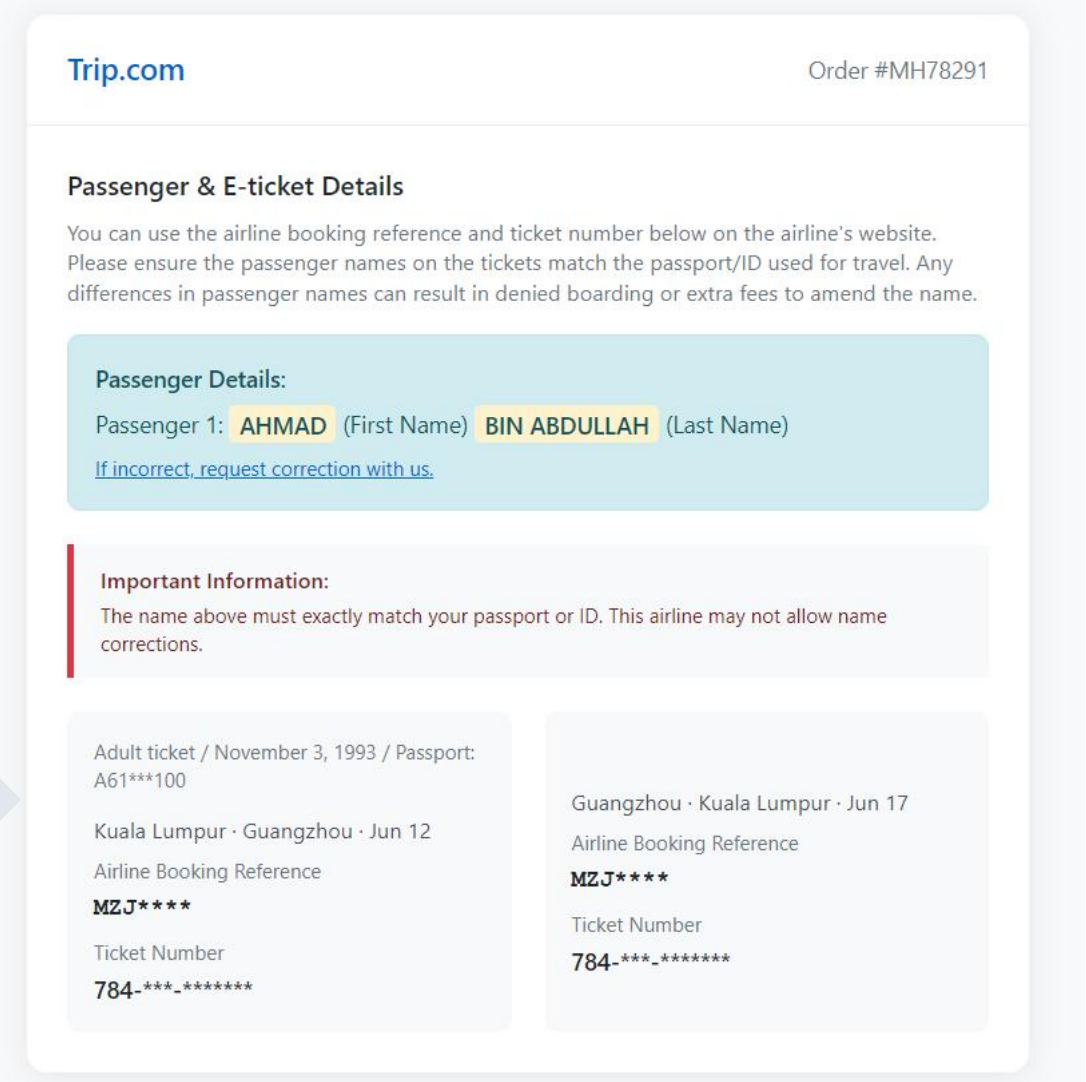
Suggestion

1. Implement a more **prominent and risk empathetic name verification reminder** to prevent denied boarding or missing the optimal modification window.
2. Provide users with **easy access to support** for correcting name errors promptly.

CURRENT **Confirmation Email**



IMPROVED **Confirmation Email** *(Prototypes after improvement as below)*



Check-in/Boarding: Emergency Handling Mechanism Optimization

Problem

~0.1% of changes occur on the same day of departure, creating urgency and stress *[Internal Data Analysis]*

Voice of Internal Interview

" The most stressful situations occur when customers are already at the airport and discover their name is wrong. They're panicking, and we need to act quickly."

- Customer Service Agent [Internal Interviews]

Key Performance Targets

- Decrease average handling time for emergency cases
- Establish direct communication channels with top 5 Malaysian airlines

Potential Areas for Improvement

(Only for Reference)

CS Training Program

Train customer service team on airline-specific emergency name handling policies and procedures

Rapid Response Protocol

Establish dedicated emergency channels with major Malaysian carriers (MH, AK, OD)

Emergency Guide

Create emergency amendment handbook with airline-specific policies, timelines and contact details

Trip.com

5. Implementation Priority Matrix

Implementation Priority Matrix

High

Impact

Low

P0

Quick Win!

- Interface terminology adjustment
- Multi-ethnic example optimization
- Double name verificaiton before payment and before ticket issue
- Help System Optimization *IQ: 44631532, 44632708, 44640632*

P1

- Smart validation system (Gender Match and Cultural Prefix Check)
- Add a Name Entry Guide
  - Airline-specific rule adaptation
  - MRZ passport guidance (Optional)
  - Special name handling guidance

P2

- Name verification enhancement in confirmation email

P2

- Optimize name correction procedures regarding NTUA

Low

Implementation Difficulty

High

P0: Immediate Implementation
Low difficulty, high impact changes providing immediate value

P1: Strategic Development
Higher effort but substantial impact solutions requiring dedicated resources

P2: Long-term Roadmap
Lower impact improvements to be addressed after P0/P1 implementations

[Comprehensive Analysis] based on impact assessment, implementation resources, and market validation

Thank You

Terima kasih!

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Appendix

1. Desktop Research file: 马来西亚机票姓名填写桌面研究报告
2. Competitor Research file: 马来西亚机票姓名填写测试结果+初步分析
3. Interview Script file: Malaysia Flight Booking Name Issues - Interview Transcripts(Cleaned)
4. Data Analysis file: MY Name Entry Data Analysis (January - June 2025)
5. Supplementary Research: Pre-submission reminders